



Apple Maps adds COVID-19 info

Apple Maps is adding a new feature that lists the COVID-19 measures airports have in place. <http://digit.in/apr21-81>



Amazon partners with Seraphim

Seraphim Capital, a space-focussed VC outfit, is partnering with Amazon for its AWS Space Accelerator. <http://digit.in/Apr21-82>

ment requires no bottlenecks to be present and that is rarely the case in a heavily customisable domain such as DIY PCs.

Even if the change is significant, then brands will issue a new model number and EAN codes to distinguish the change. What ADATA has done is nowhere close to transparent. And the fact that they've done it with not just one model but two without any public notification whatsoever goes on to tell consumers that the

brand cannot be trusted. Moreover, this isn't the first time that ADATA has been called out for switching components without issuing any notifications. Tom's Hardware highlighted the case with the SX8200 Pro which also had its components switched for inferior ones and that had significant performance penalties. They reportedly noticed a 41 per cent reduction in file copy performance and a 500 MBps drop in transfer speeds during light work-

loads. The case of the SX8200 Pro is the strangest because it wasn't just a single component being switched out but the controller, NAND and firmware were all changed. Essentially, the SX8200 Pro was completely overhauled and yet being marketed with the same model number.

What's the lesson here? Pick a respected brand. One that values their customers enough to publicly inform them of any major changes to the hardware. **[4]**

BUYING ADVICE

WORKSTATION OR GAMING?

Q Hi Agent001, I am Dileep. I am looking for a laptop for my professional work. I am not planning to use it for gaming, only for professional work. It's very confusing which processor, graphics card, brand etc. I need to choose. I have listed my current requirements below. Please suggest the best laptop.

My requirements:

1. **Use:** Only for professional use (Softwares like Altium, Orcad, Mentor Graphics PADS, Solidworks, AutoCAD, Matlab, etc.)
2. **Price:** Maximum ₹70,000
3. **Operating System:** Free DOS preferred
4. **RAM:** 8GB minimum
5. **First Hard Drive:** 256/512GB SSD preferred
6. **Second Hard Drive:** 1TB 5400/7200RPM
7. **Display:** Full HD (1920x1080) preferred
8. **Touch:** No touch preferred
9. **Camera, Microphone:** No conditions
10. **Battery:** minimum 5 hours battery backup required

Thanks for your support in advance. I am looking forward to hearing from you.

-Dileep



Hey Dileep,

The main focus here is to ensure that the laptop you pick should have the appropriate and compatible hardware for the kind of workloads that you'll be running on the machine. The software that you've mentioned, such as Altium, Orcad, PADS and Matlab will work on practically any machine since they're CPU bound whereas SOLIDWORKS and AutoCAD benefit from GPU acceleration. While the GPUs used in professional and gaming

warranty period from the vendor and the manufacturer might not support you if you get a second-hand laptop. Those concerns are secondary when you consider the fact that the lower-end models of workstations have weaker processors than what you could get with some of the consumer laptops priced at INR 50K. So we'll stick to gaming and mainstream laptops for your needs.

Some of the software you've listed have stated 16GB of RAM as the optimal amount but most laptops under INR 70K tend to come with 8 GB of RAM. This is easy to remedy since you can buy an 8 GB RAM module and upgrade your machine without voiding the warranty. We're looking at a laptop powered by Ryzen 7 / Core i7 CPU, 16 GB RAM, any decent GPU, preferably IPS display, SSD boot drive and additional storage.

The ASUS VivoBook Gaming (F571LI-AL146T) is a pretty good unit for your needs. It's got everything that you've listed including a powerful H-series CPU, 1650 Ti GPU, 8 GB of RAM, 256 GB SSD and 1 TB Hard drive. You will have to buy an 8 GB RAM module and install the same. Use a software like CPU-Z to identify the RAM module already installed and pick one that's compatible or uses the exact same metrics. Another point of concern would be the battery life. High performance and battery life do not go together. So you might be able to get about 3-4 hours of proper work (not gaming) from the laptop. **[4]**



ASUS VivoBook Gaming

graphics cards are the same, the drivers and feature sets are slightly different. Professional graphics solutions also tend to offer higher levels of precision when running calculations.

All said and done, the price becomes a point of contention. None of the laptops with Professional graphics solutions are available in the budget that you've specified. Dell, HP and Lenovo's workstations are only available from INR 90K onwards. You might be able to get some of the older models around INR 75-80K but you risk getting a shorter